

GEOGRAPHY

PHYSICAL GEOGRAPHY



CLIMATOLOGY

MODULE – 32

WORLD CLIMATIC TYPES
THE SAVANNA OR SUDAN CLIMATE
(PART-2)

WORLD CLIMATIC TYPES

2

THE SAVANNA OR SUDAN CLIMATE

HUMAN LIFE OF SAVANNA



Many different tribes in the Savanna lands are either cattle pastoralists like the Masai tribes of the East African Plateau or the settled tribes like the Hausa tribes of the northern Nigeria. Now let us examine the life of these two groups of people more closely and see how they adapt themselves to the Savanna environment.

2

THE SAVANNA OR SUDAN CLIMATE

HUMAN LIFE OF SAVANNA

THE MASAI TRIBES- CATTLE PASTORALISTS



1

At the height of their power in the mid-19th century the Masai Tribes numbered about 50,000 people. But today because of the **tribal clashes, epidemics, natural deaths** their numbers have been greatly reduced.

2

They now occupy the **less favored areas of Savanna in the East African Plateau**, which witnesses long periods of drought.

3

When there is a drought, the Masai tribes moves **upwards to the higher and cooler plateau region**, in which they graze their cattle on better patches.

2

THE SAVANNA OR SUDAN CLIMATE

HUMAN LIFE OF SAVANNA

THE MASAI TRIBES- CATTLE PASTORALISTS

- 4 The cattle kept by the Masai tribe are the Zebu cattle with humps and long horns.



- 4 The Masai tribes treat their cattle with great respect and affection. The beef of the cattle is consumed only when they die a natural death from old age or disease.

- 5 They are never used as draught animals and they are kept entirely for supply of milk and blood.

- 6 The yield of the milk is extremely low and its drunk either fresh or sour.

- 7 The richest man of the tribe has the largest herds of the cattle.

Thus, it is clear that cattle are symbols of wealth of every Masai family.

2

THE SAVANNA OR SUDAN CLIMATE

HUMAN LIFE OF SAVANNA

THE MASAI TRIBES- CATTLE PASTORALISTS

- 8** Blood from both cow and bull is drunk. This is obtained by tying a leather cord around the neck of the animal until the vein swells. The vein is then punctured by a special arrow head and the blood gushes out and is collected and drunk fresh or clotted.



2

THE SAVANNA OR SUDAN CLIMATE

HUMAN LIFE OF SAVANNA

THE MASAI TRIBES- CATTLE PASTORALISTS



9

Many Masai are responding to modern techniques but the majority stubbornly continue in their old ways.

10

Amongst most of the other African tribes, pastoralism exist side by side with agriculture.

2

THE SAVANNA OR SUDAN CLIMATE

HUMAN LIFE OF SAVANNA

THE HAUSA TRIBES- SETTLED CULTIVATORS



1

The Hausa are the tribe of Settled Cultivators who inhabit the Savanna lands of Northern Nigeria. They number almost 6 million and are more advanced in their civilization than many of other African tribes.

2

They do not practice shifting cultivation. Instead they clear a piece of land and use it for several decades.

2

THE SAVANNA OR SUDAN CLIMATE

HUMAN LIFE OF SAVANNA

THE HAUSA TRIBES- SETTLED CULTIVATORS



3

When the fertility of the plot declines they go for a new field and allow the old one to lie fallow. This enables the natural forces to act on it until fertility is restored.

4

In this manner, the Hausa rotate their crops between different fields at different parts of the year, which is technique employed in advanced agricultural societies.

5

Besides the cultivation, the Hausa also make use of the domesticated animals for both milk and meat.

2

THE SAVANNA OR SUDAN CLIMATE

PROBLEMS, PROSPECTS AND DEVELOPMENT OF SAVANNA



1

The deserts or the freezing Tundra form climatic barriers for large scale human interventions.

2

But the Savanna lands with an annual rainfall of over 30 inches and without any severe cold should be able to support a wide range of tropical crops.

3

Pioneer settlements in Central Africa, Northern Australia and Eastern Brazil have shown that the Savanna have immense agriculture potential for plantation crops like cotton, sugarcane, coffee, oil palm, groundnut & even tropical fruits.

2

THE SAVANNA OR SUDAN CLIMATE

PROBLEMS, PROSPECTS AND DEVELOPMENT OF SAVANNA

4

In West Africa commercial cultivation of groundnuts, oil palm and coco have been gradually extended into the Savanna lands.



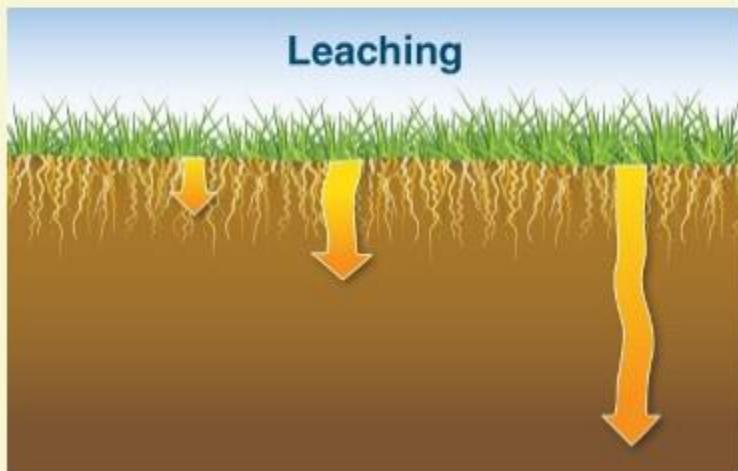
5

The States of Kenya, Uganda, Tanzania and Malawi have already taken to large scale production of cotton and hemp. New drought resistant varieties must be introduced into the Savanna lands to increase the agricultural productivity of these lands.



2

THE SAVANNA OR SUDAN CLIMATE

PROBLEMS, PROSPECTS AND
DEVELOPMENT OF SAVANNA

6

But farming in the Savanna land is not without natural hazards. **Inadequate rainfall and prolonged droughts** have made agriculture quite difficult.

7

The **Sudan climate** with distinct wet and dry periods is also responsible for rapid deterioration of soil fertility.

8

During the rainy season torrential downpours of **heavy rains** causes leaching in which most of the plant nutrients such as nitrates, phosphates or potash are washed away.

2

THE SAVANNA OR SUDAN CLIMATE

PROBLEMS, PROSPECTS AND DEVELOPMENT OF SAVANNA



9

During the **dry season** intense heating and **evaporation** dry up most of the water and because of this many Savanna areas have poor soils which are incapable of supporting good crops.

10

Unless **counter measures** like irrigation, improved crop varieties and scientific farming techniques are followed crop failures can be disastrous for these people.

11

The soil needs to be properly conserved through **regular manuring, weeding and careful maintenance**.

2

THE SAVANNA OR SUDAN CLIMATE

PROBLEMS, PROSPECTS AND DEVELOPMENT OF SAVANNA



NAGANA DISEASE

12 The Savanna is said to be natural cattle country and many of the native people are herdsmen or pastoralists. Unfortunately, the native cattle- the Zebu- are bony and yield little meat or milk.

13 They often fall victim to the tropical diseases. For example, the Sleeping Sickness carried by the Tsetse fly in Africa.

2

THE SAVANNA OR SUDAN CLIMATE

PROBLEMS, PROSPECTS AND DEVELOPMENT OF SAVANNA



14 Hybrid of temperate cattle such as the Friesian, English Shorthorn should be crossed with the tropical Zebu, if cattle rearing is to be made successful in the Savanna.

15 Cattle breeding and disease controlling must be carried out on a scientific basis.

2

THE SAVANNA OR SUDAN CLIMATE

CONCLUSION



1 There is little doubt that in the years to come world population pressure and the need for greater food production will necessitate greater economic development of Savanna.

2 And, as an agricultural region, the Savanna holds great promise for the future.

QUESTION NO - 5

Which of the following is/are unique characteristic/characteristics of equatorial forests?

1. Presence of tall, closely set trees with crowns forming a continuous canopy
2. Coexistence of a large number of species
3. Presence of numerous varieties of epiphytes

Which of the above are correct?

- | | |
|---------------|---------------------|
| a) 1 only | b) 1 & 3 only |
| c) 2 & 3 only | d) All of the above |

Ans: D

QUESTION NO - 6

Which one of the following is the characteristic climate of the Tropical Savannah Region?

- a) Rainfall throughout the year
- b) Rainfall in winter only
- c) An extremely short dry season
- d) A definite dry and wet season

Ans: D

SAVANNA IN NORTHERN HEMISPHERE

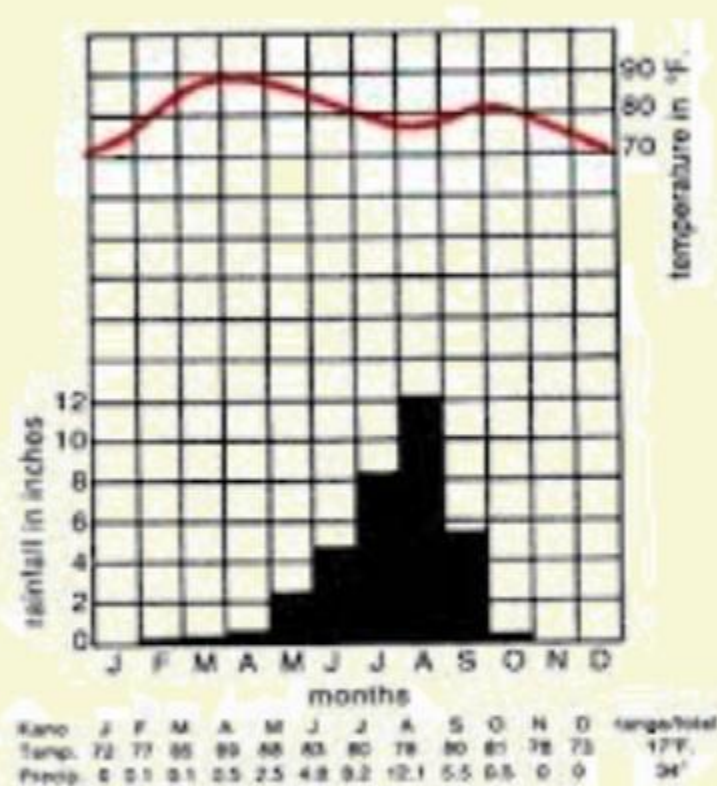


Fig. 129 (a) The Savanna or Sudan Climate in the northern hemisphere

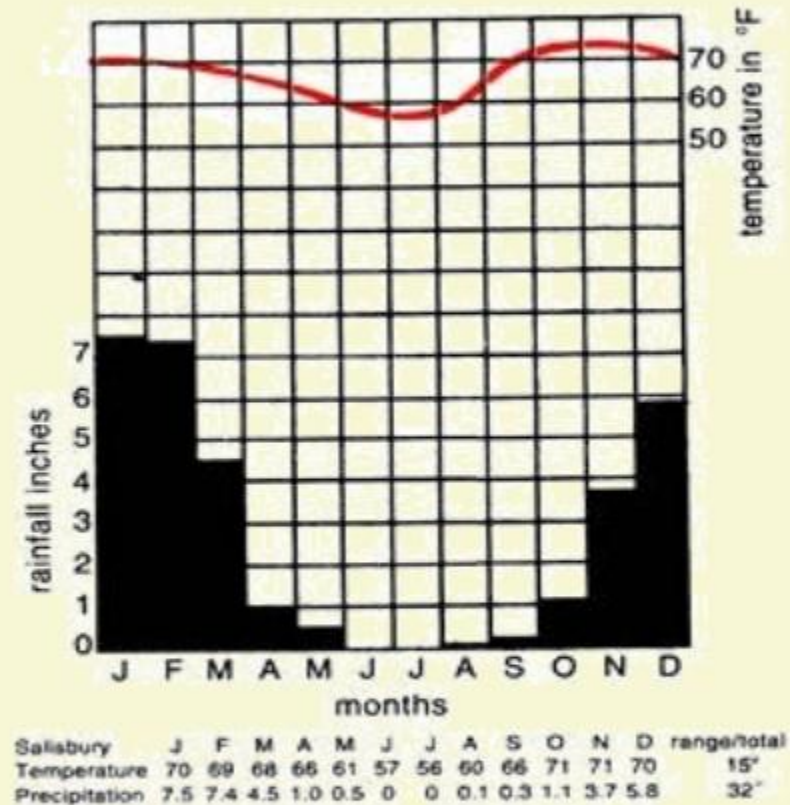
Place: Kano, Nigeria (11° 58'N., 8° 20' E.)

Altitude: 1,539 feet

Annual precipitation: 34 inches

Annual temperature range: 17°F. (89–72°F.)

SAVANNA IN SOUTHERN HEMISPHERE



(b) The Savanna or Sudan Climate in the southern hemisphere

Place: Salisbury, Rhodesia (17°45'S., 31° E.)

Altitude: 4,435 feet

Annual precipitation: 32 inches

Annual temperature range: 15°F (71–56°)

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